

Friction Grid

A printable map for noticing where friction is gathering and choosing one small place to investigate.

The Friction Grid starts with everyday irritations: places you feel drained, overloaded, tense, resistant, or stuck. Instead of treating those moments as random, the grid crosses life domains (home, work, faith, social, self) with sources of friction (internal, relational, structural) so diffuse strain becomes a visible pattern — clusters you can compare, and one practical place to experiment with change.

How to use it

1. Notice what leaves you drained, overloaded, irritated, frozen, or tense.
2. Rate each cell 1 (low), 2 (moderate), or 3 (high) — write the number in the cell, or shade it with the matching color.
3. Look across rows and columns. Which domain carries the most strain? Which source repeats?
4. On page two, name one pattern and one small experiment. No total overhaul required.

Before you mark — noticing prompts

What situations leave you feeling drained?

Where do your senses feel overwhelmed?

Who or what consistently irritates you?

When does your body resist or freeze?

Which interactions cause lingering tension?

Rating scale

1 Low friction

2 Moderate friction

3 High friction

Numbers and colors are interchangeable: 1 = low, 2 = moderate, 3 = high. Rename any domain or source label to fit your life — the pattern matters more than the wording. A high mark invites investigation; it does not prove a personal, relational, or structural cause. This is an awareness tool, not clinical, medical, legal, or financial advice.

Friction Grid

Shade, dot, or note each cell for the strain it holds right now.

1

Low

2

Moderate

3

High

	Internal	Relational	Structural
Home			
Work			
Faith			
Social			
Self			

After mapping

What stands out as a pattern?

● One small experiment to try: